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World economy to grow despite US tariffs

PARIS

The world economy will grow more than previously forecast this year after absorbing the shock of US President Donald Trump's tariffs, but their full impact remains uncertain, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) said yesterday.

In June, the Paris-based organisation had cut its forecast from 3.1 per cent to 2.9 per cent, warning at the time that Trump's tariffs would stifle the world economy.

But in an updated outlook yesterday, it raised the projection to 3.2 per cent, saying the economy "proved more resilient than anticipated" in the first half of 2025. The OECD said "front-loading" – companies rushing to import goods ahead of Trump's tariffs – "was an important source of support".

AI boost

The economy also got a boost from strong AI-related investments in the United States and government spending in China.

"The full effects of tariff increases have yet to be felt – with many changes being phased in over time and companies initially absorbing some tariff increases through (profit) margins," the OECD said.

"But (they) are becoming increasingly visible in spending choices, labour markets and consumer prices," the report added.

— AFP

At UN, Trump slams Palestine recognition as gift to Hamas

WARNS MOVE UNDERMINES PEACE, URGES GAZA TRUCE AND HOSTAGE RELEASE

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump used his return to the United Nations General Assembly yesterday to denounce growing international recognition of a Palestinian state, warning that such moves amounted to "a reward" for Hamas's attacks on Israel.

Speaking before world leaders, Trump said he has been directly involved in trying to secure a ceasefire in Gaza, nearly two years into a war that has killed tens of thousands and displaced the enclave's entire population.

He declared that recognition of Palestinian statehood by powerful nations in recent days undermined peace efforts and emboldened Hamas.

"This would be a reward for Hamas's atrocities," Trump said, to applause in the chamber, BBC reported. "Those who want peace must unite in one message: release the hostages now."

Wave of recognitions

His remarks came a day after more than a dozen nations, including France, Belgium, Luxembourg, the United Kingdom, Canada and Australia, formally recognised Palestine, joining over 145 countries worldwide. Spain, Ireland and Norway led the new wave of recognitions earlier this year.

The diplomatic shift has left Israel increasingly isolated, even as Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu vowed there would "never be" a Palestinian state.

AT A GLANCE

- Palestinian statehood:** Calls validation of Palestine a 'reward for Hamas' after UK, Canada, Australia, and France recently joined 145+ nations in recognising the enclave.
- Hostages:** Urges Hamas to release captives, says families want remains returned too.
- UN criticism:** Claims UN 'did not even try' to end wars, calls it 'empty words'.
- Seven wars:** Says he ended conflicts including Israel-Iran and Pakistan-India, though experts dispute permanence.
- Iran strike:** Boasts of ordering attack on Tehran's nuclear facility, calls Iran top terror sponsor.
- Other themes:** Rails against open borders, UN funding for migrants, warns of bioweapons and AI risks. —S.N.R.



Trump repeatedly framed Hamas as the obstacle to peace, calling the group a "terrorist organisation" that thrives on ransom and violence. He said families of the hostages in Gaza wanted the return of dead bodies as urgently as living captives.

"This is about human dignity," he said. "We cannot give Hamas concessions. The world must stand united against them."

Trump cast himself as a deal-maker seeking a breakthrough in Gaza but accused the United Nations of failing to play any role in ending the conflict. "The UN did

not even try to help," he said, arguing the world body had offered only "empty words" while violence escalated.

'Decaying the world order'

The US president's criticism extended beyond the Middle East. He accused global institutions of "decaying the world order" and said the UN had abandoned its mission to stop wars. "What is the purpose of the United Nations?" he asked. "It's not living up to its potential."

Trump contrasted his record, claiming credit for ending seven

conflicts in just seven months of his second term, including disputes between Pakistan and India and Israel and Iran.

Turning back to the Middle East, Trump described Iran as the world's leading "sponsor of terror". He also warned against open borders, accused the UN of funding migrant "invasions," and said biological weapons research risked ending life on Earth. Trump last addressed the UN General Assembly nearly five years ago, before returning for yesterday's speech.

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UAE among top global crypto hubs

Scores perfect 10 for tax-friendliness with zero levies on crypto trading and mining

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE has earned a spot among the world's top five crypto-friendly investment destinations as global cryptocurrency millionaires surge to record 241,700 individuals.

The UAE has secured a position among the world's five most crypto-friendly jurisdictions for wealthy investors, according to the newly released Crypto Wealth Report 2025 by Henley & Partners, a global advisory firm specialis-

40%

jump in global crypto millionaires in just 12 months

ing in residence and citizenship. The UAE achieved this ranking as the global count of crypto millionaires jumped by a remarkable 40 per cent in just 12 months.

The UAE scored a perfect 10 for tax-friendliness in the Henley Crypto Adoption Index, thanks to its zero taxes on cryptocurrency trading, staking, and mining activities. This places the Gulf nation alongside Singapore, Hong Kong, the USA, and Switzerland as top destinations for high-net-

worth individuals seeking crypto-friendly environments.

Digital adoption

"The UAE combines one of the most crypto-friendly tax environments with high levels of digital adoption, attracting both retail users and businesses," the report read.

Strong government backing, including Dubai's Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority and the Central Bank's Digital Dirham programme, underpins the Emirates' thriving blockchain ecosystem.

The Henley Crypto Adoption Index evaluated 29 investment migration programmes across six key parameters: Public Adoption, Infrastructure Adoption, Innovation and Technology, Regulatory Environment, Economic Factors, and Tax Friendliness.

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